

Physical Assessment

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Chapter 13: four ideas to connect

Signs and symptoms

Combine objective signs and subjective symptoms to understand the patient's condition.

Health history

Use respectful, organized questions about current concerns, health, medications, allergies, and support.

Connected assessments

Understand how provider diagnosis and ongoing nursing assessment contribute different information.

Systematic examination

Use an organized approach, protect comfort and privacy, and report important changes.

Put the chapter into safe practical nursing care

A consistent assessment helps you notice what has changed.

Begin with the patient's concern, collect a focused history, and examine in a systematic order. Compare findings with baseline and expected results, then promptly report significant changes.

- ✓ Explain and protect privacy
- ✓ Collect subjective symptoms
- ✓ Observe objective signs
- ✓ Follow a consistent sequence
- ✓ Compare, document, and report

RECOGNIZE → ACT → REPORT

Ask the concern.
Examine in order.
Report the difference.

Before moving on, explain the cue, your immediate action within scope, and the facts you would report.